

Conservatoire. By 1835, Franck had made sufficient progress to perform at public concerts in Brussels and Aachen, and the entire family moved to Paris to help promote the youngster's career.



CHAMBER MUSIC CONCERT

This painting (c. 1885–1890) by Jules- Alexandre Grün shows Franck leaning on the piano (far right), listening to a performance by the artist's future wife, Juliette Toutain, and two other musicians.

In search of recognition

Critics have questioned the wisdom of this push for success. Always a quiet lad, Franck was denied part of his childhood, and the pressure may have affected the development of his natural talent. He entered the Paris Conservatoire in 1837, where he won a number of awards, but the big prize, the Prix de Rome, eluded him.